Maintainer Prioritization in npm Supply Chains: Objectives, Representation Sensitivity, and Metadata Limits

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Statements and Declarations

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Competing Interests

Both authors declare that they have no financial or non-financial competing interests relevant to this work.

Data Availability

The retained metadata, derived analysis tables, and artifact manifests supporting this study are maintained in the project repository. A versioned public replication release is being prepared before submission. A publicly accessible release URL and persistent identifier are not yet available; the deposited version, access link, and any exclusions must be specified in the final submission. This draft therefore does not claim that the supporting data are already publicly accessible.

Code Availability

The project repository contains the collection and analysis scripts, numerical consistency checks, figure-generation scripts, and manuscript sources. These materials are intended to accompany the public replication release described above. Reproducing the retained-graph analyses requires the archived observations; repeating live API requests may return different metadata.

Ethics and Consent

The study analyzes public software-ecosystem metadata and does not involve recruited human participants, interventions on individuals, or execution of package payloads. No participant consent was collected. Usernames are used as observed graph identifiers, without inferring misconduct or present-day account security. The prospective observations contain no measured incident outcomes at the time of this manuscript.

Publication Status

Neither the conference-length draft nor the journal manuscript has been published, accepted, or is under review elsewhere. This manuscript is not an extension of a previously published conference paper.

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